no promote jihad as an individual obligation, Lashkar leaders believe the other organizations within Pakistan's Ahl-e-Hadith movement have 'deviated from the pure Salafia school of Faith.'[96] This puts Lashkar at odds with the mainstream Ahl-e-Hadith organizations, which historically made it difficult for the group to recruit from Ahl-e-Hadith madaris, the great majority of which are controlled by the MJAH. Thus, it was forced to construct its own network and support structure. This is an entirely different situation from that which existed for the major Deobandi outfits.

Jihadi group decisions about where to operate, as well as the nature of objectives and activities in those loci of operation, are not as discrete as the division between the Deobandi and Ahl-e-Hadith schools of thought. Once again, the three loci are Afghanistan, Indian-administered Kashmir and sectarianism in Pakistan. The Afghan locus was connected to the Kashmir and sectarian loci during the 1990s because many of the major jihadi groups fighting in Indian-administered Kashmir or waging sectarian war in Pakistan trained in Afghanistan. Connections to Afghanistan for all of the major Deobandi militant groups were stronger than for Lashkar, and went beyond the use of the country for training purposes. Cadres from all of the major Deobandi outfits fought alongside the Taliban and some of their leaders held posts within the Taliban government as well. This inevitably brought them closer to Osama bin Laden's circle, a relationship explored in greater detail in Chapter 5. Specifically, Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami [HuJI] and Harkat-ul-Mujahideen [HuM] fought in the Kashmir jihad, but as the 1990s progressed they became more motivated by events in Afghanistan. Sipah-e-Sahaba Pakistan [SSP] and Lashkar-e-Jhangvi [LeJ] were situated primarily within the locus of sectarian violence in Pakistan, but also shared similarly strong connections with the Taliban in Afghanistan. When Jaish-e-Mohammad emerged it automatically had pre-existing connections with each of these three loci. Jaish was a splinter of HuM, from which it drew most of its cadres, and so it shared that group's connection to the Kashmir jihad and Afghanistan. It also shared members with SSP and LeJ, which meant it was situated in the sectarian locus as well. JeM's primary focus was on the Kashmir theater where it was a some-time ally and often a competitor with Lashkar, but had competing interests in the Afghan and sectarian loci as well as a weak ideological foundation owing to the nature of its emergence as a splinter group. The Deobandi groups were not only active in multiple loci, but, as already discussed, were all connected to one